



TELECOM ENGINEER

JOB DESCRIPTION

A telecommunications—or telecom—engineer works with a variety of technologies that enable the exchange of data and communications. These include cell and fixed-line telephones, radio, cable or wireless broadband Internet, fiber optics, and satellite-based systems. As a telecom engineer, you design, install, test, or repair these systems for clients that may range from large organizations to individual customers.



SALARY

Graduate trainee engineer ★★☆☆☆

Senior telecom engineer ★★★★★

INDUSTRY PROFILE

Growing sector due to increase of technologies • Employers include manufacturers of communications systems and devices, government departments, and telecom providers

AT A GLANCE



YOUR INTERESTS Electronics • Information Technology (IT) • Electrical engineering • Software engineering • Mathematics • Physics



ENTRY QUALIFICATIONS A degree in telecommunications, electrical engineering, computer science, or a related subject is required.



LIFESTYLE Full-time office hours are the norm, but telecom engineers may have to work overtime to meet deadlines. Self-employed contract work is common.



LOCATION Engineers mostly work in an office, but travel is required for site visits, meetings, or conferences. Working remotely from home is also possible.



THE REALITIES Meeting delivery deadlines can be stressful. However, working at the forefront of developing technologies can be rewarding.

CAREER PATHS

Telecommunications engineering is a broad field. Following a degree, most telecom engineers join a graduate training program and specialize in an area, such as broadcast technology or computer networks. You must continue learning throughout your career to keep pace with fast-changing technologies.

TECHNICIAN Studying at a vocational school will enable you to work as a technician, testing and maintaining telecom equipment. You can then study for a degree while employed.



GRADUATE With a degree in a technical subject, you can enter a company's graduate training program. You can increase your chances of entry with previous work experience, such as an industrial placement.

